

AI Creator Growth Playbook

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Snapshot

[@shashwat__agarwal](#) reached 99.6k followers on just 80 posts by turning AI tool tips into fast talking-head reels with a "comment X and I'll DM you" hook. Bio positioning: "I save time & money with AI · Building & Automating Businesses", managed by an agency (@hookmedia.mgmt), with a Linktree for free resources and consultations.

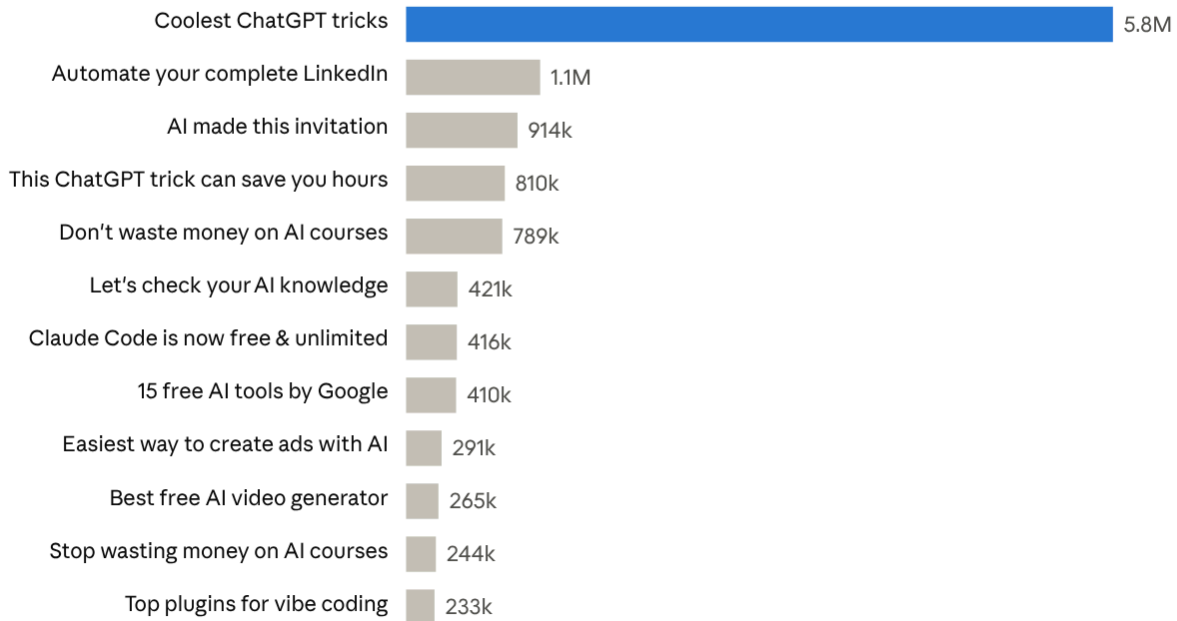
- **Growth inflection was around July 2026.** His older reels (torn-paper title cards, mixed topics like weight loss, yoga and procrastination) mostly got 1.5k to 23k views. After he switched to a tight AI-only niche plus a new format, reels started hitting 200k to 5.8M.
- **Of the 48 reels on his grid, 15 cleared 200k views and 3 cleared 900k.** The top reel (Coolest ChatGPT tricks) has 5.8M views, 109.8k likes and 57.9k comments.
- **Language:** Hinglish voiceover with English on-screen titles, aimed at Indian students, freelancers and small-business owners.
- **Monetisation path:** brand deals through a management agency, consultations, and a lead list built from the DM funnel.

What's working

His winners are tool tips with a big-name AI brand in the title and a comment keyword at the end.

One ChatGPT tips reel is his breakout hit

Top 12 reels by views; the leader has 5.3x the views of the next best



View counts from his Reels grid, read 5 Oct 2026

Comment-gated reels pull more comments than likes, which is the signal that pushes them to non-followers.

Reel	Likes	Comments	Call to action
Coolest ChatGPT tricks	109.8k	57.9k	Comment ChatGPT for the codes
Automate your complete LinkedIn	20.5k	47.5k	Comment anything for the repo (11 AI agents)
Don't waste money on AI courses	14.6k	30.1k	Follow and comment anything for the link
AI made this invitation	13.4k	29.2k	Comment Wedding
Claude Code is now free	7.5k	23.6k	Comment for setup guide
Let's check your AI knowledge	13.6k	2.4k	Comment your score
This ChatGPT trick can save you hours	8.6k	66	None (pure value, spread by shares)

His strategy decoded

His growth engine is one repeatable loop: a big-promise title card, a 20 to 40 second Hinglish demo of one AI tool, then a comment keyword that triggers an auto-DM with the link.

1. **Comment-to-DM funnel (the main growth lever).** Almost every top reel ends with "Comment ChatGPT / anything / your score and I'll DM you the link". This drives huge comment counts (57.9k on the top reel, 47.5k on the LinkedIn-agents reel, more comments than likes), which the algorithm reads as strong engagement. The DM is likely automated with a tool such as ManyChat, and some captions add "Follow &" before the comment ask.
2. **One promise per reel, written as an outcome.** Titles sell a result, not a tool: "Automate your complete LinkedIn", "Get Jobs with Claude", "Stop wasting money on AI courses", "This ChatGPT trick can save you hours". The bio repeats the same promise: save time and money with AI.
3. **Free and "secret" framing.** Many winners promise something free or insider: "Claude Code is now free & unlimited", "15 Free AI tools by Google", "Best Free AI video generator", "Free Gemini Pro for students".
4. **Riding the news cycle.** He posts fast on launches: ChatGPT ads in India, ChatGPT 6 review, Claude Design, Claude working for longer, new plugins for vibe coding.
5. **Name-brand tools in the title.** ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini and Google appear in most top titles. People search and recognise these names, so the hook lands in under a second.
6. **Low-production, high-energy format.** Selfie-distance talking head, a wireless mic held in hand as a prop, warm indoor light, white serif text in a black box at the top, Hinglish subtitles, a trending song underneath. It looks native to Reels, not like an ad.
7. **Personal story spikes.** "AI made my engagement invitation" (914k) mixed his real life with AI and asked for a "Wedding" comment. "I'm 28 and quit my 20 LPA job" style posts build the person behind the tips.
8. **Interactive quizzes.** "Let's check your AI knowledge" (API, MCP, RAG, AI agents) hit 421k by asking viewers to comment their score, which turns watchers into commenters.
9. **Series and episodes.** Captions like "Ep 19: Saving your cost and time with AI" and "Day 1 of AI Tools" give returning viewers a reason to follow.
10. **Pinned proof.** His three biggest reels are pinned, so every new profile visitor sees 5.8M, 1.1M and 914k first, which raises follow rate.

The playbook for AI and AI agents

Copy his loop, then differentiate on AI agents, where most Indian AI creators still only cover ChatGPT tricks.

1. **Pick a sharp positioning line.** One promise, one audience. Examples: "I build AI agents that do your work", "AI agents for small businesses", "I automate jobs with AI agents". Put it in your name field too (e.g. "Your Name | AI Agents") so it shows in search.
2. **Set up the profile to convert.** Bio = promise + proof + CTA ("Free agent templates below"). Link to a free resource hub (Notion, Linktree or Gumroad). Pin your 3 best reels as soon as you have winners.
3. **Build the comment-to-DM machine before posting.** Set up ManyChat (or Instagram's built-in automation) with one keyword per reel. Each DM delivers a real asset: a GitHub repo, n8n workflow JSON, a prompt pack, a Claude or GPT setup guide. Ask for a follow before the link to convert commenters into followers.
4. **Make the asset worth commenting for.** Agent-niche lead magnets: ready-to-import n8n or Make workflows, a CrewAI or LangGraph repo, a Claude Code skill or MCP server, a "10 agents for freelancers" Notion doc.
5. **Lock a repeatable format.** Talking head, phone at arm's length, mic in hand, black-box title on top, burned-in captions, trending audio at low volume. 20 to 45 seconds. Cut every pause.
6. **Hook in the first 1.5 seconds.** Title card states the outcome and the spoken first line repeats it. Show the result on screen early (the agent output, the dashboard, the saved hours).
7. **Show the screen, not just your face.** For agent content, use split screen or green-screen over the tool: workflow canvas, terminal, the agent completing a task. This is the proof that makes people save and share.
8. **Post 5 to 7 reels a week for 90 days.** He posted roughly every 1 to 3 days. Batch-record 6 to 8 reels in one session.
9. **Mix 70 / 20 / 10.** 70% tool demos and agent builds, 20% news reactions within 24 hours of a launch, 10% personal story or opinion.
10. **Recycle winners.** When a reel beats 3x your average, remake the same idea with a new tool or angle within a week (he did this with "Stop wasting money on AI courses" and "Don't waste money on AI courses").
11. **Cross-post everywhere.** Same video to YouTube Shorts, LinkedIn and X. Agent and automation content performs especially well on LinkedIn for B2B leads.
12. **Monetise from day one.** DM list → newsletter or WhatsApp channel → paid templates, consulting, or done-for-you agent builds. Brand deals follow at around 50k to 100k followers.

Content pillars and 30 reel ideas

Five pillars cover the niche; each idea below is written as a ready title card with its DM keyword.

Pillar	Share of posts	What it proves
Agent builds	35%	You can make agents that do real work
Tool tricks	25%	Fast, saveable value with big-name tools
AI news in 24h	20%	You are the first place to learn what changed
Quizzes and myths	10%	Drives comments and debate
Personal AI story	10%	Makes people follow you, not just the tip

Agent builds

1. "I built an AI agent that replies to all my emails" — comment EMAIL
2. "This AI agent finds 100 clients while I sleep" — comment LEADS
3. "Team of 5 AI agents runs my Instagram" — comment TEAM
4. "AI agent that applies to jobs for you" — comment JOBS
5. "Turn Claude into your personal CA" — comment TAX
6. "I replaced my VA with an n8n agent" — comment N8N
7. "AI agent that edits my reels" — comment EDIT
8. "Build your first AI agent in 60 seconds, no code" — comment AGENT

Tool tricks

9. "5 Claude Code commands nobody uses" — comment CLAUDE
10. "This ChatGPT setting doubles your output" — comment GPT
11. "Free AI tools by Google that feel illegal" — comment FREE
12. "MCP explained in 30 seconds" — comment MCP
13. "Make Gemini watch YouTube for you" — comment GEMINI
14. "Prompt that turns any AI into a coding agent" — comment PROMPT

AI news in 24 hours

15. "[New model] just dropped, here is what changes for you"
16. "[Tool] is now free in India"
17. "OpenAI vs Anthropic vs Google agents, honest test"
18. "This AI launch will kill [job / app]"

19. "I tested [new agent product] for 24 hours"
20. "Biggest AI update this week in 40 seconds" (weekly series)

Quizzes and myths

21. "Let's check your AI agent knowledge" (RAG, MCP, tool calling) — comment your score
22. "Chatbot vs AI agent, most people get this wrong"
23. "Stop paying for these 5 AI tools"
24. "Don't learn AI from courses, learn it from this" — comment LEARN

Personal AI story

25. "I let AI agents run my day for 7 days" (series)
26. "AI planned my whole trip" (use a real trip)
27. "How AI saved my small business ₹50,000"
28. "My parents tried AI for the first time"
29. "I built a startup with only AI agents" (series, day 1 to 30)
30. "What I would do if I started AI content today"

Script template and first 30 days

Every reel follows the same five beats, 25 to 40 seconds total.

Beat	Time	What you say or show	Example
Hook	0–2 s	Outcome title card plus the same line spoken	"This AI agent finds clients while I sleep"
Proof	2–6 s	Show the result on screen	Sheet filling with 100 leads
Steps	6–30 s	3 fast steps, screen recording, one line each	"Open n8n, paste this, connect Gmail"
Payoff	30–35 s	Why it matters in time or money	"Saved me 10 hours a week"
CTA	last 3 s	Follow + comment keyword	"Follow and comment LEADS, I'll DM the workflow"

Caption formula: one-line outcome, 2 to 3 lines of context, "Follow & comment KEYWORD for the link", 3 to 5 hashtags (#AIagents #ChatGPT #ClaudeAI #automation #AItools).

First 30 days

- ☐ Week 1: rewrite bio and name field, set up ManyChat, build 5 lead magnets, record 8 reels in one batch day
- ☐ Week 1: post 5 reels (3 agent builds, 1 tool trick, 1 quiz)
- ☐ Week 2: post 6 reels, add one news reaction within 24 hours of a launch
- ☐ Week 2: reply to every comment in the first hour after posting
- ☐ Week 3: find your top 2 reels by shares and saves, remake both with a new angle
- ☐ Week 3: start a numbered series ("AI Agent Ep 1") and a personal story reel
- ☐ Week 4: pin your 3 best reels, cross-post all reels to Shorts and LinkedIn
- ☐ Week 4: collab reel with one creator of similar size in AI or business

Metrics and mistakes

Judge each reel on shares, saves and comments per 1,000 views, not on likes.

Metric	Where to find it	Good target
3-second hold rate	Reel insights	60%+
Average watch time	Reel insights	70%+ of length
Shares per 1k views	Reel insights	10+
Comments per 1k views	Reel insights	20+ with a DM keyword
Follows per 1k views	Reel insights	3+
DM link clicks	ManyChat	30%+ of DMs sent

Mistakes to avoid

- **Mixing niches.** His early yoga, weight-loss and productivity reels stalled at 1.5k to 10k views. Stay on AI and agents.
- **Pretty but slow covers.** The designed torn-paper thumbnails underperformed the plain talking-head-plus-title format.
- **DM bait with no value.** If the link is thin, people stop commenting next time. Deliver a real repo, workflow or guide.
- **Jargon in the hook.** Say "AI that books your meetings", not "agentic RAG pipeline". Teach the jargon later in quiz reels.
- **Overpromising.** Claims like "free and unlimited" must be true; fake claims bring angry comments and lost trust.
- **Ignoring comments.** Reply fast in the first hour; it extends reach.

Sources

- [@shashwat__agarwal Reels grid](#) (views read on 5 Oct 2026)
- Top reels opened: [Coolest ChatGPT tricks](#), [Automate your complete LinkedIn](#), [AI made this invitation](#), [This ChatGPT trick can save you hours](#), [Stop wasting money on AI courses](#), [Let's check your AI knowledge](#), [Claude Code is now free](#)
- Targets in the metrics table are common benchmarks, not his numbers.